

# Hymn of Breaking Strain

*He went over it in his head, plate by plate, span by span, brick by brick, pier by pier,  
remembering, comparing, estimating, and recalculating, lest there should be any mistake;  
and through the long hours and through the flights of formulae that danced  
and wheeled before him, a cold fear would come to pinch his heart...*

Text: Rudyard Kipling, 1935, alt.

Music: Leslie Fish, 1983

BREAKING STRAIN 76.76.76.76.6

arr. Kenan Schaefkofer, 2021

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|   |                |                   |            |                                  |
|---|----------------|-------------------|------------|----------------------------------|
| 1 | The care - ful | text-books        | mea - sure | (Let all who build be - ware!)   |
| 2 | But in our     | dai - ly          | deal - ing | with stone and steel, we find    |
| 3 | The pru - dent | text-books        | give it    | in ta - bles at the end:         |
| 4 | We on - ly     | of Cre - a - tion |            | (Oh, luck - ier bridge and rail) |
| 5 | Oh, veil - ed, | se - cret         | Pow - er,  | whose paths we seek in vain,     |

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|   |            |                |             |                               |
|---|------------|----------------|-------------|-------------------------------|
| 1 | the load,  | the shock, the | pres - sure | ma - ter - i - al can bear.   |
| 2 | the gods   | have no such   | feel - ing  | of guilt for hu - man - kind. |
| 3 | the stress | that shears a  | riv - et,   | or makes a tie - bar bend,    |
| 4 | a - bide   | the twin dam - | na - tion:  | To fail and know we fail.     |
| 5 | be with    | us in our      | hour —      | of ov - er - throw and pain;  |

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|   |                 |               |           |                                    |
|---|-----------------|---------------|-----------|------------------------------------|
| 1 | So when a       | buck - led    | gir - der | lets down a steel cas - cade,      |
| 2 | To no set       | gauge they    | make us,  | for no laid course pre - pare,     |
| 3 | what traf - fic | wrecks mac -  | a - dam,  | what con - crete should en - dure. |
| 4 | Yet we —        | by which sole | to - ken  | we know we once were gods —        |
| 5 | that we —       | by which sure | to - ken  | we know Thy ways are true —        |

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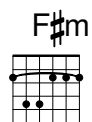
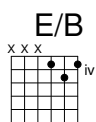
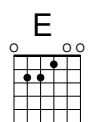
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|   |                     |                |            |                                |
|---|---------------------|----------------|------------|--------------------------------|
| 1 | the blame for       | loss, or       | mur - der  | is on the ma - ker laid.       |
| 2 | and pres - ent - ly | o'er - take us |            | with loads we can - not bear:  |
| 3 | But we, of          | Eve and        | A - dam    | have no such lit' - ra - ture, |
| 4 | take shame in       | be - ing       | bro - ken, | how - ev - er great the odds.  |
| 5 | be - cause of       | be - ing       | bro - ken, | may rise and build a - new.    |



Oh\_\_\_\_\_ the ma - ker, not the made!  
 too mer - ci - less to bear.  
 to warn us or make sure!  
 Oh\_\_\_\_\_ the bur - den of the Odds.  
 stand up and build a - new.